WORLDQUANT UNIVERSITY

Capstone Project Report Guidelines

MScFE 690

Capstone Course

Revised: 08/04/2020

Overview

This document provides important guidelines on how to organize the information in your Capstone Project following the requirements of a scientific publication.

It is important that you begin to organize the information as you begin to work on the Project Proposal early in the course. Then, you will continue to develop your report using the same document and structure which will evolve into the Draft Project and the Final Project to be submitted at the end of the Capstone Course.

Please make use of the LIRN Library that you can access using the link on the left pane of your screen as one of your primary resources for your capstone research.

Your research should favor authoritative, scholarly sources, and you **must cite** all sources where relevant. **The task is not to reproduce the research of others, but instead to develop your own systematic narrative that addresses the research topic and is informed by the research of others**. Not only are you required to cite accurate and relevant facts, but you must also present your own clear logic when linking and contextualizing these facts.

Note: The Project Proposal, Project Draft, and Final Project based on these guidelines must be submitted via **Turnitin**, the anti-plagiarism software.

Abstract

The purpose of an abstract is to summarize the key information in your report, including the research goals, design, and major findings of your research. This section should be as concise as possible (typically no longer than 300 words) and give the reader a clear understanding of what to expect in the report.

Introduction

An introduction should establish the context and purpose of your report. In this section, you should pose the question or hypothesis that is going to be investigated in the following sections, as well as discuss the theoretical background and rationale of the report to the reader.

Theoretical Framework

This section provides a more comprehensive, critical discussion of the existing research and literature on the topic of your report. It is important to only include relevant literature that provides context to your research question or hypothesis.

©2019 - WorldQuant University - All rights reserved.

Methodology

Use this section to outline how you conducted your research study. This includes the specific techniques and tools you used to collect and analyze your data, any constraints you encountered as well as how you were able (or unable) to manage these constraints.

Results

The Results section is where you will present your data. Use figures, tables, and graphs to clearly represent information in a logical order. Only include the data that is most relevant to your report in this section. If you want to include additional or non-essential data for context or clarity, you can add an appendix at the end of your report.

Discussion

In this section, you will analyze the data you presented in your results and interpret this data in light of your research question or hypothesis. Use this section to explain what your results mean and how they relate to, or contribute to, existing research and knowledge in the field.

Conclusion

The conclusion is where you will provide a concise summary of your results and findings. It is very important that no new ideas or data are introduced in your conclusion. Make sure you include all the key information that was presented in the results and discussion.

References

This section is a comprehensive list of the literature and research you cited in your report. This list should be alphabetical and formatted correctly according to the referencing style you have used in your report.

Appendix

The appendix is an optional section at the end of the report that can be used to include additional information or data for clarity or interest. You can refer to the appendix throughout your report.

Submission Requirements

The PDF file with your Project Proposal, Draft Project, or Final Project **must be uploaded separately** from the zipped folder that includes your other files. This allows Turnitin to generate the similarity report.

©2019 - WorldQuant University - All rights reserved.